

PHASE 1 – IDEATION PHASE

MODULE 1.1 – PROBLEM STATEMENT

1.1.1 Introduction

The ideation phase focuses on identifying the major problems in the existing IT laptop procurement process and understanding how the process can be improved through automation. In many organizations, employees who require a standard laptop need to submit a request and wait for different teams to review, approve, process, and fulfil the request.

When these activities are handled manually, the process can become time-consuming and difficult to track. Therefore, identifying the actual problem is the first step toward designing an effective automated solution.

1.1.1 Existing Problem

The existing standard laptop procurement process involves multiple manual activities. An employee submits a laptop requirement, the request is reviewed by the responsible person, approval is obtained, and the IT or procurement team processes the order.

Since several activities are dependent on manual communication and follow-up, the process may experience delays. Employees may also have limited visibility into the current status of their requests.

The major problems identified are:

- Manual submission and processing of requests.
- Delays in obtaining approvals.
- Repetitive work for IT and procurement teams.
- Manual assignment of procurement tasks.
- Difficulty in tracking request status.
- Communication gaps between employees and responsible teams.
- Lack of centralized process management.
- Need for frequent follow-up from employees.

1.1.3 Problem Analysis

The main issue is not the laptop itself but the way the procurement request is processed. A single request may pass through several stages before it is completed.

For example, an employee may submit a request and then wait for approval. After approval, the responsible team needs to identify the request and perform the required procurement activities. If any stage is missed or delayed, the overall process is affected.

Manual processing also increases the possibility of inconsistent handling of requests. Different requests may be processed differently depending on the person handling them.

1.1.4 Need for Automation

Automation can reduce the amount of manual work involved in the procurement process. A workflow can automatically perform predefined activities after a request is submitted.

Using ServiceNow Flow Designer, the system can:

1. Receive the laptop request.
2. Trigger the procurement workflow.
3. Send the request for approval.
4. Continue processing after approval.
5. Create or assign tasks to the responsible team.
6. Update the request status.
7. Notify the employee about important updates.

This provides a structured and consistent process.

1.1.5 Proposed Problem Solution

The proposed project addresses the identified problems by automating the standard laptop procurement process using *ServiceNow Flow Designer*.

Instead of depending on manual communication for every stage, the workflow controls the movement of the request from submission to completion.

The proposed process is:

Employee → Laptop Request → Approval → Automated Task Assignment → Procurement Processing → Laptop Fulfilment → Status Update

This approach helps reduce unnecessary manual activities and provides better visibility into the request.

1.1.6 Expected Improvement

The proposed solution is expected to provide:

- Faster request processing.
- Reduced manual effort.
- Automated approval handling.
- Better task assignment.
- Improved request tracking.
- Consistent workflow execution.
- Better communication through notifications.
- Centralized management of procurement requests.

1.1.7 Conclusion

The problem statement identifies the major limitations of the existing manual laptop procurement process. Delays, repetitive work, communication gaps, and limited tracking can affect the employee experience and the efficiency of IT teams.

The proposed solution uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the standard laptop procurement workflow and create a more organized and transparent process.